Year 10 Admission Assessment

Version 3.1, October 2026

Name	
Date	

Welcome

These activities help us get to know you.

Do your best.

It is fine if you cannot answer every question.

Your teacher will tell you when to start each part.

How to answer

Tick one box.

Which one is a fruit? a chair ☐ an apple ☑ a bus ☐

Write your answer in the box.

12 + 8 = **20**

Show your working. You can get marks for your working, even if your answer is wrong.

Working

4 × 25 = 100, 100 + 30 = 130

The parts of this paper

Part	What you do	Time
Listening	Listen to two talks. Answer 16 questions.	15 minutes
Reading	Read two texts. Answer the questions.	15 minutes
Writing	Write a description or an article.	10 minutes
Break		5 minutes
Maths	Fluency, word questions and applied problems.	25 minutes
Science	Questions with pictures, tables and graphs.	8 minutes
Interview	Talk with a teacher and read some sentences aloud.	15 minutes

You may use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler.

You may use a calculator **only** in Maths Section C.

Listening

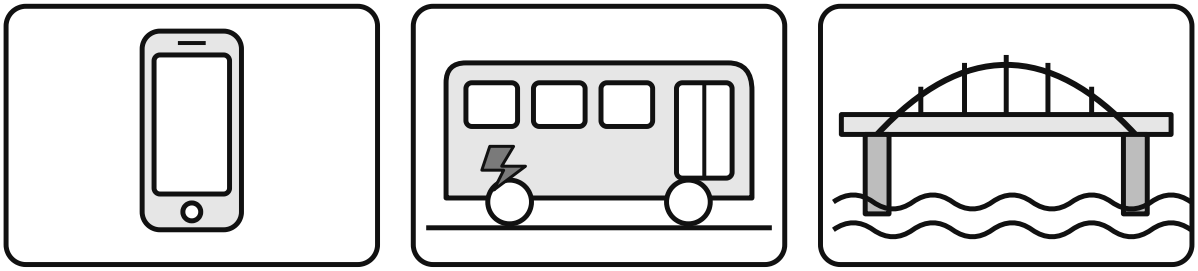
There are two parts: **A** and **B**.
Your teacher will read each part **two times**.
Listen carefully.
Before each part, you have one minute to read the questions.
You can answer while you listen, or after.

Part A

You will hear a short talk. **Answer** questions 1 to 8.

1 / 1

What does Dr Liu's company design?
Tick one picture.



A ☐ B ☐ C ☐

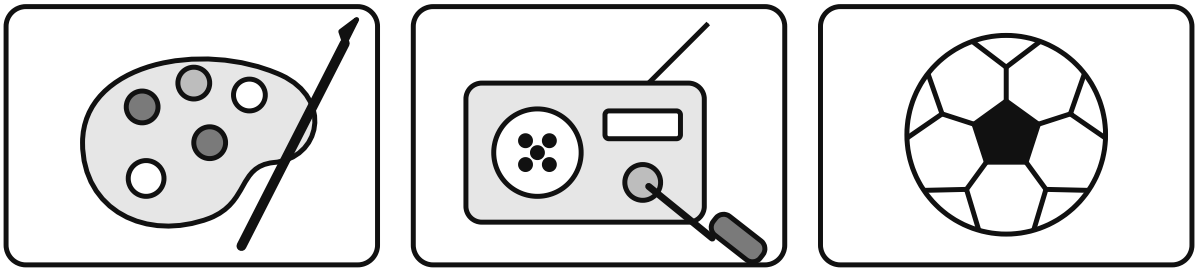
2 / 1

What was Dr Liu's favourite subject at school?
Tick one.

☐ Art ☐ Maths ☐ Physics

3 / 1

What did Dr Liu do at the weekends when she was young?
Tick one picture.



A ☐ B ☐ C ☐

4 / 1

How many years did she study at university? ☐

5 / 1

How many people are in her team? ☐

6 / 1

How far can the newest bus travel before it needs charging? ☐ km

7 / 1

Dr Liu says, "My parents weren't always happy about that!"
Why do you think her parents were not happy?

8 / 1

Why does Dr Liu tell the students that her first battery design failed every test?

Part B

You will hear a talk by **Professor Zhou Lan**. She is a scientist who studies the climate of cities.
Your teacher will read the talk **two times**.
You have one minute to read questions 9 to 16 first.

9 / 1

In the largest cities, on the hottest nights, how much warmer can the city centre be than the countryside?

[ ] degrees

10 and 11 / 2

Complete the notes. **Write** one to three words in each gap.

Example: Roads, concrete and dark roofs absorb the sun's energy in the day. They release it after [**sunset**].

Notes: why are cities hotter?

10 Plants cool the air. Water travels up from the soil, [ ] from the leaves and carries heat away.

11 Waste heat comes from traffic and from [ ].

12 / 1

A green roof has four layers.
Write 1, 2, 3 and 4 to show the order of the layers. 1 is the **bottom** layer.

Layer	Order
soil	[ ]
plants	[ ]
a waterproof layer	[ ]
a drainage layer	[ ]

13 / 1

Professor Zhou's team tested two roofs on a July afternoon.
What temperature did the surface of the **dark** roof reach? [ ] °C

14 / 1

Professor Zhou talks about a "vicious circle".

Explain how a green roof on a building could help to break this circle.

15 / 1

Builders often say that green roofs are too expensive.

What does Professor Zhou think about this? **Tick** one.

- ☐ She agrees that green roofs cost too much to build.
- ☐ She thinks they forget the cost of a city that is too hot.
- ☐ She thinks they should build white roofs instead.
- ☐ She thinks they do not know how green roofs are built.

16 / 1

What is the main purpose of Professor Zhou's talk? **Tick** one.

- ☐ To warn that cities will soon be too hot for people to live in.
- ☐ To explain a problem in cities and suggest how the school could help.
- ☐ To show that green roofs are cheaper than white roofs in the end.
- ☐ To report the results of her team's research in Hangzhou.

Reading

There are two parts: **A** and **B**.
Part B is harder than Part A.
Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.
You have 15 minutes. When you finish, wait for your teacher.

Part A

Read the menu. Then **answer** questions 1 to 7.

Lotus Café

Fresh noodles, rice and snacks, made every day

Opening hours
Monday to Friday: 7:30 to 20:00
Saturday and Sunday: 9:00 to 21:00

Noodles and rice

Beef noodle soup	spicy	¥32
Tomato and egg noodles	vegetarian	¥24
Chicken fried rice		¥28
Vegetable fried rice	vegetarian	¥22
Spicy tofu with rice	vegetarian, spicy	¥26

Snacks

Pork dumplings (8)		¥18
Spring rolls (4)	vegetarian	¥15

Drinks

Milk tea	¥14
Orange juice	¥16
Water	¥5

Key
vegetarian (no meat or fish)
spicy

Student deal
Any noodle dish
+ any drink = ¥35
Monday to Friday, 14:00 to 17:00
Show your student card.

Allergies?
Please tell our staff before you order.

1 / 1

What time does the café open on Sunday? _____

2 / 1

How much is the beef noodle soup? _____

3 / 2

Tick the **two** dishes that are vegetarian.

- ☐ Beef noodle soup
- ☐ Tomato and egg noodles
- ☐ Chicken fried rice
- ☐ Spring rolls
- ☐ Pork dumplings

4 / 1

Aisha is vegetarian. She does not like spicy food.

Write one dish from "Noodles and rice" that she can choose.

_____

5 / 1

When can you get the student deal? **Write** the days and the times.

_____

6 / 1

What must you show to get the student deal? _____

7 / 1

You have an allergy. What should you do?

_____

Part B

Read the article. Then **answer** questions 8 to 14.

Ten Minutes of Nothing

By Zhang Yiran, Year 11

When did you last do nothing at all? I do not mean sleeping, and I do not mean scrolling through videos. I mean sitting still, with no screen, no music and no plan, and simply letting your mind wander.

If you are like most teenagers I know, you probably cannot remember. The moment we feel even slightly bored (in a queue, on the bus, while a video is loading) our hands reach for our phones. Boredom feels like a problem, and our phones offer an instant solution.

I would like to suggest that boredom is not a problem at all. In fact, it may be one of the most useful feelings we have.

Psychologists describe boredom as a kind of signal. It tells us that what we are doing is not satisfying, and it pushes us to look for something better. When we fill every empty moment with a screen, we never hear that signal. We stay busy, but we are not really choosing what to do with our time.

There is also evidence that a wandering mind can be a creative one. In one study, a group of adults spent fifteen minutes copying numbers from a long list. Afterwards, they were asked to think of as many uses as possible for two plastic cups. They came up with more ideas than a group who had skipped the boring task. The researchers believe that boredom gives the mind time to make unexpected connections.

Of course, nobody enjoys being bored for hours, and I am not suggesting that we throw our phones into the nearest river. My suggestion is much smaller: try ten minutes of nothing each day. Leave your phone in your bag on the way home. Look out of the window. Notice where your thoughts go.

The first few minutes will feel strange, perhaps even uncomfortable. But you may be surprised by what your mind does when you finally give it some space.

8 / 1

What does the writer say most teenagers do when they feel bored?

9 / 1

What does "instant" mean in "our phones offer an instant solution"? **Tick** one.

☐ expensive ☐ immediate ☐ difficult ☐ boring

10 / 1

According to psychologists, what does boredom tell us?

11 / 1

In the study, what did the bored group do better than the other group?

12 / 2

Tick Fact or Opinion for each sentence.

Example: Hangzhou is a city in China. Fact ☑ Opinion ☐

Sentence	Fact	Opinion
In one study, a group of adults spent fifteen minutes copying numbers.	☐	☐
Boredom is not a problem at all.	☐	☐
The bored group came up with more ideas than the other group.	☐	☐
Boredom may be one of the most useful feelings we have.	☐	☐

13 / 1

"I am not suggesting that we throw our phones into the nearest river."
Why does the writer include this sentence?

14 / 1

The article begins with a question: "When did you last do nothing at all?"
Why do you think the writer begins in this way?

Writing

Choose one task: A or B.

Tick the box for the task you choose.

Plan your ideas in the plan box. Then **write** on the lines.

You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can.

Task A: a description ☐

Describe a busy place you know well. For example: a market, a train station or a festival.

Help the reader to see, hear and smell the place.

Ideas: the people, the sounds, the smells, the colours, how the place makes you feel.

Task B: an article ☐

Some people say:

> Every student should spend one week each year volunteering in their community, for example in a library, a park or a home for older people.

Do you agree? **Write** an article for the school website. Give your opinion, with reasons and examples.

Plan

Notes and ideas (this part is not marked)

Your writing

Task A ☐ Task B ☐

Maths

You have 25 minutes. Do as much as you can.

Write your answer in the box. **Show** your working in the working box.

Your teacher can read any question to you.

Sections A and B: you may **not** use a calculator.

Section C: you **may** use a scientific calculator.

Section A: Fluency

No calculator

What the maths words mean

Simplify fully: write it as simply as you can, for example $\frac{2x + 4}{x + 2} = 2$

Surd form: keep the square root in your answer, for example $\sqrt{12} = 2\sqrt{3}$

Make *a* the subject: $b = a + 2$, so $a = b - 2$

f(x) = 2x + 1 means "double x, then add 1". So f(3) = 7.

fg(x) means "do g first, then do f". **$f^{-1}(x)$** is the **inverse** of f: it undoes f.

1 / 1

Write $\sqrt{48} - \frac{6}{\sqrt{3}}$ in the form $k\sqrt{3}$.

2 / 1

Work out $27^{-2/3}$. **Give** your answer as a fraction.

3 / 2

Simplify fully $\frac{2x^2 + 5x - 3}{x^2 - 9}$

Working

4 / 2

Make x **the subject** of $y = \dfrac{2x + 3}{x - 1}$

Working

$x =$

5 / 2

$f(x) = 3x - 1$ $g(x) = x^2 + 2$

(a) **Work out** $fg(2)$.

(b) **Find** $f^{-1}(x)$. $f^{-1}(x) =$

6 / 2

Solve $\dfrac{3}{x + 1} + \dfrac{2}{x} = 1$

Give your answers in surd form.

Working

$x =$ or $x =$

Section B: Word questions

No calculator

The questions in this section are in words only.
Read each question carefully. Decide what to do.

Write an equation, then solve it.
Three consecutive numbers add up to 87. Find the numbers.
(Consecutive numbers come one after another, like 5, 6 and 7.)

Let the smallest number be n. The numbers are n, $n + 1$ and $n + 2$.
Equation: $n + (n + 1) + (n + 2) = 87$
Solve: $3n + 3 = 87$, so $3n = 84$, so $n = 28$.
Answer: the numbers are 28, 29 and 30.

7 / 2

The price of a concert ticket goes up by 15%.
The new price is ¥230.
Work out the price before it went up.

Working

¥

8 / 2

At a museum, 3 adult tickets and 4 student tickets cost ¥290 altogether.
2 adult tickets and 5 student tickets cost ¥275 altogether.
Write two equations, then **solve** them.
Find the cost of one adult ticket and the cost of one student ticket.

Working

Adult ticket: ¥ Student ticket: ¥

9 / 2

A rectangle has a perimeter of 34 cm.

Its area is 60 cm^2.

Write an equation, then **solve** it.

Find the length and the width of the rectangle.

Working

Length: ☐ cm Width: ☐ cm

10 / 2

Pump A can fill an empty water tank in 4 hours.

Pump B can fill the same tank in 6 hours.

Both pumps are switched on at the same time.

How long do the two pumps take to fill the empty tank together?

Give your answer in hours and minutes.

Working

☐ hours ☐ minutes

Section C: Applied problems

You may use a scientific calculator

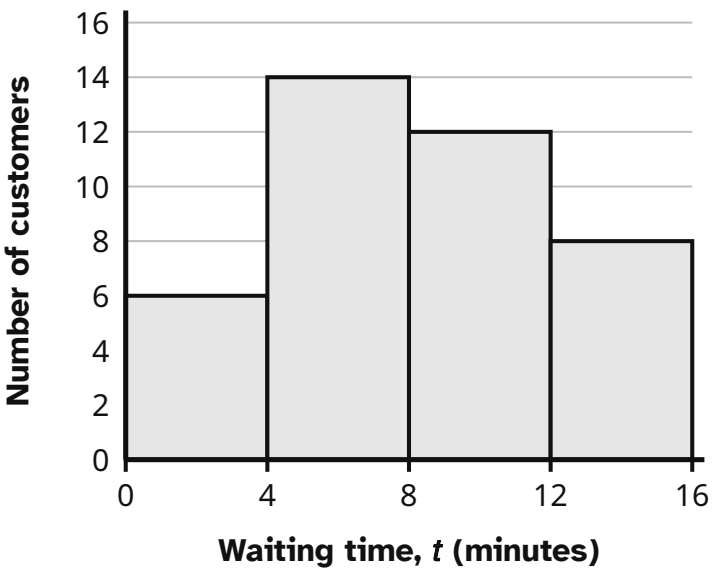
Show your working. You can get marks for your working, even if your answer is wrong.

11 / 2

A café records how long 40 customers wait for their food.
The chart shows the results.

Work out an estimate of the mean waiting time.

Working



minutes

12 / 2

A new laptop costs ¥6000.
Its value goes down by 12% every year.
After how many whole years is the laptop first worth **less than** ¥3000?
You can use the table.

Year	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Value (¥)	6000	5280						

years

13

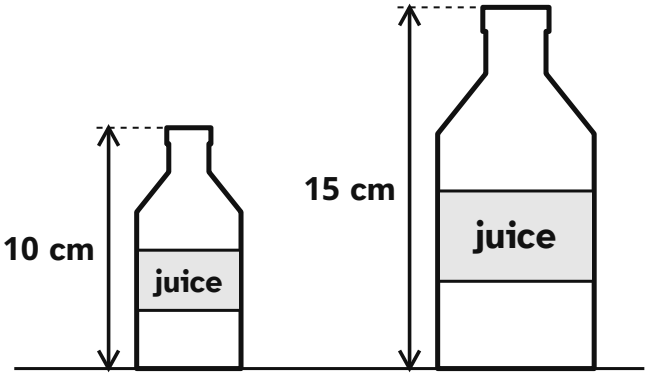
/ 2

These two bottles of juice are mathematically similar.

The small bottle is 10 cm tall.
It holds 200 ml. It costs ¥12.
The large bottle is 15 cm tall.
It costs ¥36.

Which bottle is better value? **Show** how you decide.

Not drawn accurately



Small: 200 ml, ¥12 **Large: ¥36**

Working

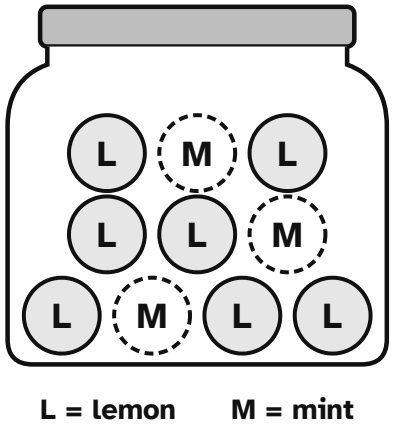
Tick one. Small bottle ☐ Large bottle ☐

14

/ 2

A jar has 10 sweets.
7 are lemon (L) and 3 are mint (M).
Jun takes a sweet at random and eats it.
Then he takes another sweet at random.

Work out the probability that the two sweets are the **same** flavour.



L = lemon **M = mint**

Working

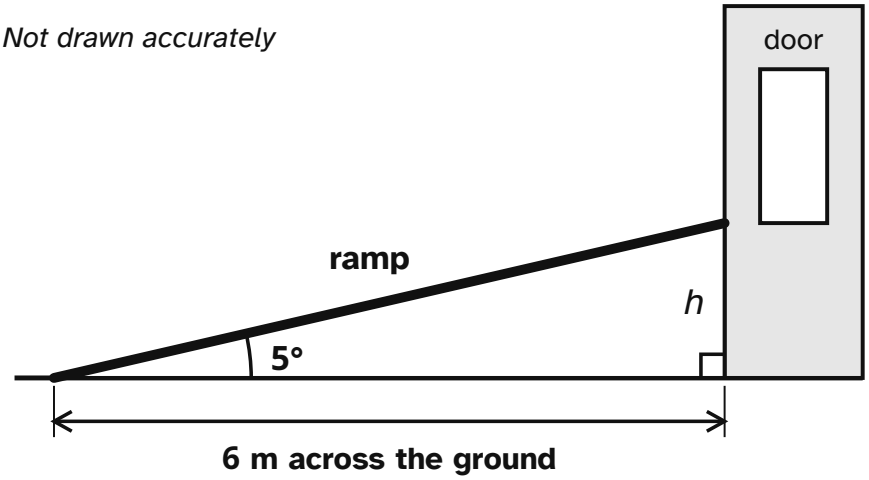
15

/ 2

This is a rule for wheelchair ramps:

> A ramp must not be steeper than **1 in 12**. For every 12 m across the ground, it can rise at most 1 m.

Not drawn accurately



This ramp goes 6 m across the ground. It makes an angle of 5° with the ground.
Does this ramp follow the rule? **Explain** your answer.

Working

Tick one. Yes, it follows the rule. ☐ No, it is too steep. ☐

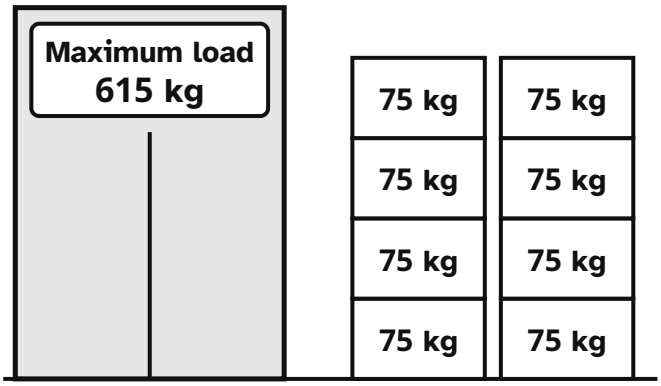
16

/ 2

A lift can carry a maximum load of 615 kg.
There are eight boxes.
Each box has a mass of 75 kg, correct to the nearest 5 kg.

Can the lift **always** carry all eight boxes at the same time? **Explain** your answer.

Working



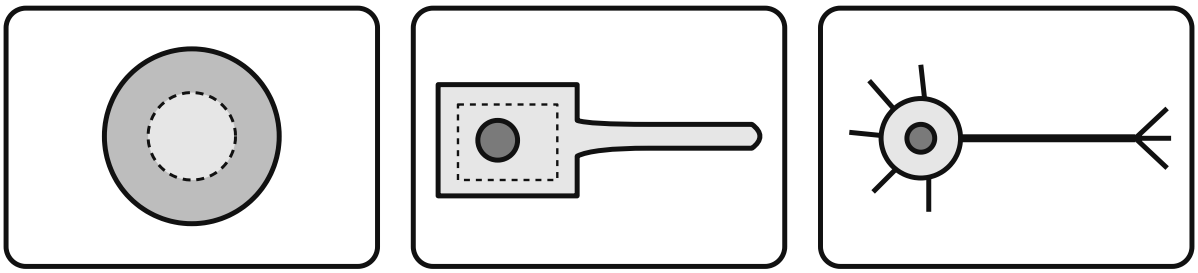
Tick one. Yes ☐ No ☐

Science

You have 8 minutes. Do as much as you can.
Your teacher can read any question to you.

1 / 1

These are three specialised cells.

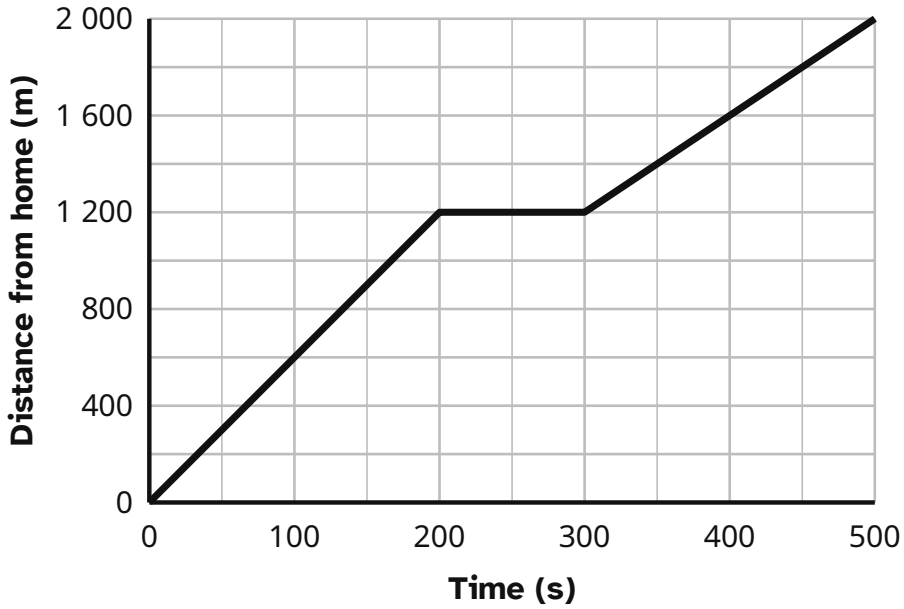


A **B** **C**

Which cell takes in water from the soil? **Write** the letter. ____

2 / 2

Jun cycles from home to school. This graph shows his journey.



(a) What is Jun doing between 200 s and 300 s? ____

(b) **Work out** Jun's speed in the first 200 s. Use: speed = distance ÷ time.

____ m/s

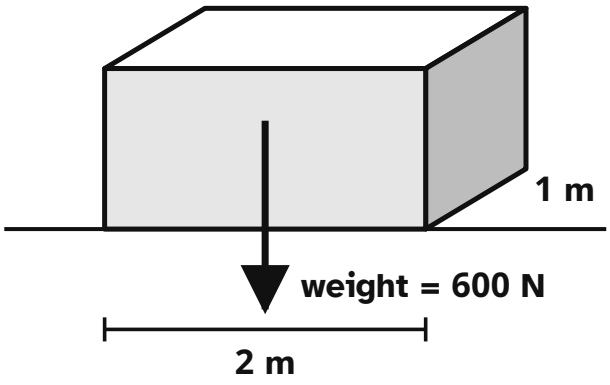
3 / 1

A box weighs 600 N.
Its base is 2 m long and 1 m wide.

Work out the pressure of the box on the floor.

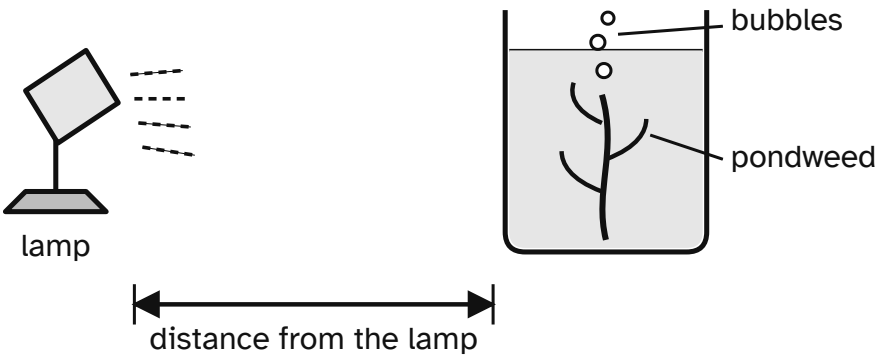
Use: pressure = force ÷ area.

_____ N/m^2



4 / 3

Sofia investigates how light affects photosynthesis. She puts a lamp at different distances from some pondweed. She counts the bubbles of gas in one minute.



Distance from the lamp (cm)	**10**	**20**	**30**	**40**
Number of bubbles in one minute	52	31	17	9

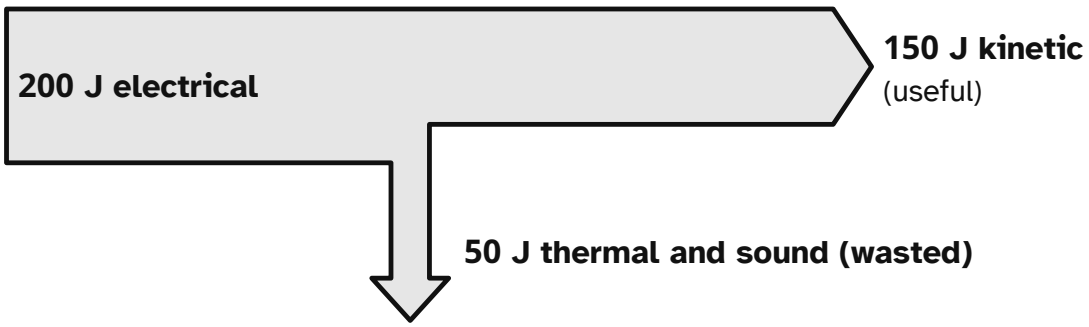
(a) **Describe** the pattern in the results.

(b) **Write** one variable Sofia must keep the same.

(c) Sofia counted the bubbles only once at each distance. **Suggest** one way to improve her method.

5 / 1

This diagram shows the energy transfers in an electric fan.

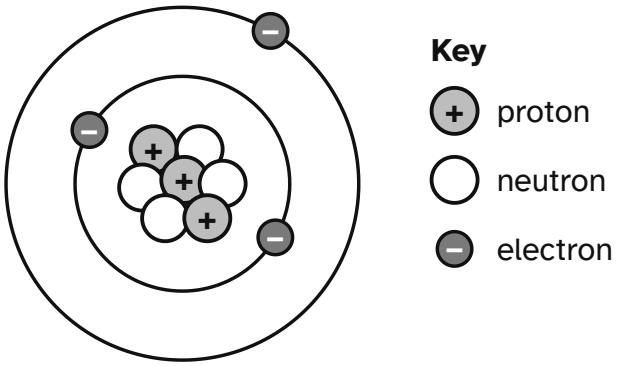


Work out the efficiency of the fan. Use: efficiency = useful energy out ÷ total energy in.

6 / 1

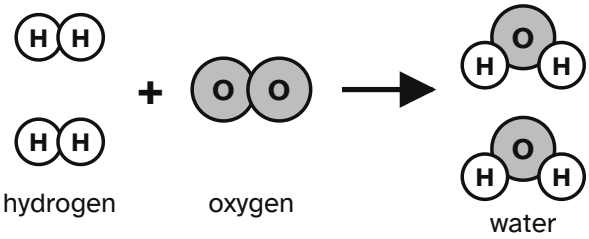
This diagram shows an atom.

What is the **mass number** of this atom?



7 / 1

Hydrogen reacts with oxygen to make water.



Write the missing number to balance the equation.

$$\square\ H_2 + O_2 \rightarrow 2H_2O$$

Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.

Year 10 grading sheet (version 3.1)

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Date of birth		**Current school**	
Date of assessment		**Assessor**	

Paper version sat: v3.1 (on the front page of the student paper). **For staff only.** Mark the student paper first (every question has a mark box; answers and mark schemes are in `Y10_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`). Copy the totals here and give the bands from the guide below. Reading is recorded on the **Reading front sheet** and speaking on the **Interview sheet**.

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening (Part A / 8, Part B / 8)	A ___ + B ___ = ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	Part B not given? ☐
Writing (four criteria, each / 4)	content ___ vocabulary ___ grammar ___ spelling and punctuation ___ = ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	Task chosen: A B
Maths (Fluency / 10, Word questions / 8, Applied / 12)	F ___ + W ___ + A ___ = ___ / 30	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	NT: L:
Science (/ 10)	___ / 10	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	NT: L:
Reading	Reading front sheet		
Speaking	Interview sheet		

Maths profile. Fluency ___ % · Word questions ___ % · Applied ___ %.

☐ Fluency much higher than word questions: was the barrier English? (A word question solved after it was read aloud or given in Chinese.)

☐ Fluency and word questions much higher than applied: needs teaching in problem solving and explaining.

Not yet taught (NT) topics, and the likely maths and science band once taught:

Access arrangements (extra time, reader, breaks) and **behaviour and wellbeing** during the assessment:

Assessor's comment (strengths, English barrier or not, what support the student would need, anything to follow up):

Assessor signature and date _____

Readiness for IGCSE (Section 6 of `Y10_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`; read the results together first)

Decision	Tick one in each row
English course	☐ English as a Second Language ☐ First Language ☐ To decide
Maths tier	☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ To decide
Readiness	☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet
Maths support	☐ English of maths ☐ Problem solving ☐ Content gaps ☐ None

Band guide at a glance (full guide and judgement notes: `Y10_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`)

Band	Listening (/ 16)	Writing (/ 16; best fit decides)	Maths (/ 30)	Science (/ 10)
A or **1**	Part A 0 to 2	0 to 3	1 Below expected: 0 to 10	1: 0 to 3
B or **2**	Part A 3 to 4	4 to 7	2 Working towards: 11 to 16	2: 4 to 5
C or **3**	Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	8 to 10	3 Expected: 17 to 22	3: 6 to 8
D or **4**	Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	11 to 13	4 Greater depth: 23 to 30	4: 9 to 10
E	Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	14 to 16		

Reading front sheet: reading levels and sentence reading

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date of birth**	
Age today (years:months)		**Date**	

For staff only. One sheet for each candidate, all year groups. The assessor fills in Part 1 and gives this sheet to the interviewer (usually the principal) before the interview. The interviewer, or in Years 1 to 3 the assessor, runs the sentence reading with `Sentence_Reading_Guide` and records it in Part 2. Part 3 gives the reading result for the final mark sheet.

1. Reading levels so far (the assessor fills this in)

Item	Details
Handed over by, and time	Handed over by _____ at _____ Received by _____
Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen (its Sheet 13)	Letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 Phonics words ___ / 40 Tricky words ___ / 20 Book band _____ (Oxford Level ___) Accuracy ___ % Questions ___ / ___
Years 4 to 6: reading paper	Part A ___ / 8 Part B ___ / 8 Part C ___ / 8 Total ___ / 24
Years 7 to 12: reading paper	Part A ___ / 8 Part B ___ / 8 Total ___ / 16 Stopped at 15 minutes at question ___
Reading band so far	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D ☐ E
Sentence reading starts at	☐ the level for the year group (table below) ☐ Level 1, because the student is new to English
Tell the interviewer	(for example: shy, needs more time, stopped early, anxious about English)

Year group	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Start at level (first sentence)	1 (1)	1 (1)	2 (4)	3 (7)	4 (10)	5 (13)	6 (16)	7 (19)	8 (22)	9 (25)	9 (25)	9 (25)

2. Sentence reading (Graded Sentence Reading Screen)

Run by: ☐ interviewer ☐ assessor (Years 1 to 3, after the Early Reading Screen). Write 2, 1 or 0 for each sentence (none, one, two or more errors), then the meaning check and the level total. **Levels below the start level:** write 6 in the total if the student scored 6 out of 6 on the start level (guide, Section 1). **Stop** at the end of a level with 2 points or fewer, after three 0s in a row, or if the student is upset.

Level	Sentence a	Sentence b	Sentence c	Meaning check	Level total
1 (sentences 1 to 3)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
2 (4 to 6)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
3 (7 to 9)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
4 (10 to 12)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
5 (13 to 15)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
6 (16 to 18)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
7 (19 to 21)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
8 (22 to 24)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
9 (25 to 27)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
10 (28 to 30)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
11 (31 to 33)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
12 (34 to 36)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6

Errors, what the student said when you are not sure, and **patterns noticed** (S substitution, O omission, I insertion, T told; SC self-correction is not an error). Patterns such as missing -ed or -s endings, or pinyin letter values, are useful evidence:

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3. Result (copy to the final mark sheet)

Measure	Result
Total points (including 6 for each level below the start level that was not read)	___ / 72
Reading age (5:00 plus 2 months for every point: 6 points = 6:00, 12 = 7:00, 30 = 10:00, 60 = 15:00, 72 = 17:00)	_____ : _____
Actual age (years:months) and difference (reading age minus actual age)	Actual _____ : _____ Difference _____ months
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	___ asked, ___ ✓
Fluency on the last level read with 4 or more points (1 word by word, 2 two or three words, 3 sensible phrases, 4 smooth)	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4
Indicative reading band from the sentence reading (table below)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Reading band for the final mark sheet (the Early Reading Screen in Years 1 to 3, the reading paper in Years 4 to 12; if it differs from the sentence reading by more than one band, say why)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Band from the reading age (the full guide and the notes are in `Sentence_Reading_Guide`)

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 12	Band
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below	up to 12 months below	**E**
Below	7 to 12 months below	13 to 24 months below	**D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below	25 to 42 months below	**C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below	43 to 60 months below	**B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below	more than 60 months below	**A**

Years 1 and 2: use the reading age as supporting evidence only. If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one (decoding ahead of understanding).

Interview sheet: Years 7 to 10

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date**	
Interviewer		**Others present**	

Questions and descriptors: `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`. Sentence reading is recorded on the Reading front sheet. For staff only.

Speaking and listening

Speaking band: ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Listening in conversation (how much of your English they understood): ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand):

Key things the student said (their own words, and how they said it)

Suitability

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Strand	Rating	Evidence (a short quotation or what you saw)
Attitude to learning and resilience	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence and self-management	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Values and conduct	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for English-medium learning	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Clarity and ownership of future plans	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Boarding readiness (only if the student will board)	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	
Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans	☐	

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

First impressions, and what the student would need in the first weeks:

Interviewer's comment for the final mark sheet

Strengths, concerns, support:

Interviewer signature and date _____

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Final mark sheet: candidate summary and decision

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date of birth**	
Current school		**Date of assessment**	

Paper version sat: _____ (v3.1; on the front page of the student paper). Complete within two working days from the **grading sheet**, **Reading front sheet**, **Interview sheet**, parent conversation record and homeroom teacher reference. This is the one overview that the head of section reads and that goes into the admissions system. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (copy the scores)	Band
Listening	Grading sheet: ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation (Interview sheet)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Speaking	Interview sheet (and picture talk on the grading sheet, Years 1 to 3)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Reading	Reading front sheet. Years 1 to 3: book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics ___ / 40 ; letters ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 6: paper ___ / 24. Years 7 to 12: paper ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Reading aloud	Sentence reading (Reading front sheet): points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Writing	Grading sheet: ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems (Years 7 to 12: fluency) / word problems (word questions) / applied (Years 7 to 12)	Not yet taught (NT) and language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	___ / ___ ___ / ___ ___ / 12	
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4		

1 Well below expected (Years 7 to 12: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The Years 7 to 12 papers are harder, so their boundaries are lower. Strong number problems with weak word problems may be an English barrier, not a maths difficulty. Years 7 to 12: strong fluency and word questions with weak applied problems means teaching in problem solving, not more content. NT questions score 0: say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Years 10 and 11: readiness for IGCSE (grading sheet; Section 6 of the year's instructions). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet ☐ (Year 11) start in Year 10.

Years 11 and 12: optional sciences and cognitive ability screen (grading sheet). Biology ___ / 15 band ___ Chemistry ___ / 15 band ___ Physics ___ / 15 band ___ (blank if not taken). Cognitive screen: non-verbal ___ / 12 quantitative ___ / 12 verbal ___ / 12 processing speed ___ / 60. Profile note: _____ (for planning

support, never for selection). **Year 12: readiness for A Level** (Section 6 of the Year 12 instructions): ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Pre-A Level year advised ☐ Not yet.

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Interview sheet (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Comments and feedback

Assessor (from the grading sheet): strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not.

Interviewer (from the Interview sheet): what the student is like, hopes and plans, anything of concern.

Feedback for the family. Start with the child's strengths; use plain words; say what support we will give and, if no offer is made, what would change the decision.

7. Sign-off and records

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Interviewer			
Head of section			
Admissions: outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			

Papers filed together: ☐ grading sheet ☐ Reading front sheet ☐ Interview sheet ☐ parent conversation record ☐ marked student paper. Assessment result and report given with the marked papers on: _____
Entered in the admissions system: date _____ initials _____

Assessment result and report

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date of birth**	
Current school		**Date of assessment**	

Paper version sat: _____ Assessor: _____ Interviewer: _____ Report date: _____

Outcome (from the final mark sheet, confirmed by the head of section): ☐ Offer ☐ Offer with English support ☐ Offer with a learning plan ☐ Further assessment before a decision ☐ Unable to offer at this time. Year group confirmed: _____

Results

	Score	Band	What we found (a few words)
Listening	__ / __	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Speaking (interview)		☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Reading	__ / __ reading age _____	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	Book band (Years 1 to 3):
Writing	__ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Overall English		☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Maths	__ / __	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	Topics not yet taught:
Science (Years 5 to 10)	__ / __	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Strengths

What to work on

Support we recommend from the first day (English support, maths and science catch-up, where to start reading)

Next step and review date

Head of section (name, signature, date) _____

Admissions (name, signature, date) _____

The bands show where the student is now and what support will help. They are not a pass mark. The back of this sheet explains them.

About this report

This report goes with the student's marked papers. It was made from the grading sheet, the reading and interview sheets and the parent conversation. The assessment was in English only, so the English bands show how far the student's English has come, and maths and science show what the student can do when the English is not the barrier. Some topics are taught in a different order in Chinese schools: where a student has not yet been taught a topic it scores 0 and the report says so.

The English bands

Band	Listening	Speaking	Reading	Writing
A New to English	Understands little or no English; may follow a routine instruction with gesture.	Silent, or single words and memorised phrases; may use Chinese.	May know some letter names or sounds; reads few or no words.	Copies, writes their name, or writes isolated words; may write in Chinese.
B Early acquisition	Understands simple, slow questions and instructions on familiar topics, with support.	Short phrases and simple sentences about familiar things; frequent errors.	Decodes simple words and short sentences; understands very simple texts with pictures.	Short simple sentences with familiar words; frequent errors in grammar and spelling; meaning mostly clear in short pieces.
C Developing competence	Follows most everyday talk and simple explanations; misses detail and implied meaning.	Connected sentences with "because", "but", "so"; errors common but meaning usually clear; everyday vocabulary.	Reads simple texts two or more years below age level with understanding; struggles with age-level texts.	A short connected piece; some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; basic punctuation.
D Competent	Follows most classroom talk at normal pace, including some implied meaning.	Speaks at length, explains and gives examples; occasional errors.	Reads age-level texts with some difficulty in vocabulary and inference.	Organised writing with a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; varied vocabulary.
E Fluent	Understands as a fluent speaker of the same age does.	Fluent and accurate for age.	Reads age-level texts as a fluent reader of the same age does.	Writing comparable to a fluent writer of the same age.

Reading age is an indicative figure from a short reading-aloud screen: 5 years 0 months plus 2 months for every point. It is a guide, not a standardised test.

Maths and science bands compare the score with what is expected for the year group: 1 Well below expected, 2 Working towards, 3 Expected, 4 Greater depth. The papers for older students are harder, so their boundaries are lower.

If you have questions about this report, contact the admissions office.